Kootam — Product Requirements

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1. Overview

Kootam is a web app that gives recurring offline communities one link per event for payments, RSVPs, waitlists and check-in. The MVP targets run clubs and pickleball groups in Coimbatore.

Problem. Organisers run events through WhatsApp groups, Google Forms and UPI screenshots. That costs them:

- hours matching UPI payments to names
- 30–40% of free RSVPs not turning up (estimate, to be confirmed in interviews)
- manual waitlists and "anyone dropping out?" messages
- no member list, attendance history or recurring fees

Product. An organiser creates an event and shares its link in the group. Members RSVP or pay in one tap. Extra people join a waitlist automatically. Hosts scan QR codes at the venue. Deposits go back to people who showed up.

Goals for the MVP (first 90 days after launch)

1. 20 Coimbatore communities run every event through Kootam.
2. Show-up rate of 85% or more at events that use deposits.
3. 40% of attendees come to a second event within 4 weeks.
4. First paid-ticket revenue through the platform fee.

Non-goals for the MVP

- Concerts and large ticketed events (BookMyShow and District already serve these)
- Native mobile apps (mobile web only)
- Chat inside the app (WhatsApp stays the chat)
- AI features
- Cities outside Coimbatore, Bengaluru and Chennai

2. Users and roles

The app has three platform roles. Power inside a community comes from being its owner or co-host, not from the platform role.

Role	Who	Main job in the app	How they log in
Member	Anyone who attends events	Join communities, RSVP or buy tickets, show a QR code at the venue	Google or phone OTP
Organiser	Runs a community (e.g. a run-club founder)	Everything a member can do, plus create communities and events, check people in, see revenue	Google or email + password
Co-host	A member or organiser added to one community by its owner	Manage that community's events and check-in. Cannot remove the owner or change payouts	Same as their own role
Admin	Kootam team	Verify payout accounts, suspend users or communities, change settings	Email + password

Personas for the wedge

- **Arun, run-club founder, 29.** 180 people in his WhatsApp group, a Sunday 6 a.m. run and a monthly paid event. Spends Saturday nights matching UPI payments. Wants payments and no-shows handled for him.
- **Divya, pickleball group admin, 34.** Books two courts every weekday evening and splits the cost across 8 players. Loses money when people drop out late. Wants deposits and a waitlist that fills the gap.
- **Karthik, attendee, 22.** A college student in three groups. Wants to grab a spot in one tap, without filling in a form each time.

3. MVP scope

The MVP covers one community's full event loop: create, share, register, pay, check in, settle. Anything that doesn't serve that loop waits.

Area	In the MVP	Later
Communities	Create, edit, public page, join or leave, co-hosts	Sub-groups, multiple chapters per city

Area	In the MVP	Later
Events	Free, paid and deposit events; capacity; registration cutoff; publish; cancel; complete	Recurring event series, multi-day events, ticket tiers
Registration	One-tap RSVP, auto-waitlist, waitlist promotion, cancel within the policy	Group tickets (+1s), custom questions on the form
Payments	Razorpay UPI and cards, seat holds, deposit refunds, refunds when a host cancels	Monthly memberships, coupons, wallet
Check-in	QR scan by host, manual check-in from guest list, no-show marking	Self check-in by geofence
Payouts	Razorpay Route linked account, admin verification	Instant payouts, GST invoices
Notifications	WhatsApp or SMS confirmation, reminder 12 hours before, waitlist offer	Broadcast to all members, in-app chat
Discovery	City page listing public events	Search, recommendations, "friends going"
Analytics	Per event: registered, checked in, revenue. Per community: regulars, members who went quiet	Cohort reports, CSV export
Admin	Payout queue, suspend user or community, platform settings	Support inbox, dispute tooling

4. Functional requirements

There are 42 requirements. All 28 marked P0 must ship before the Coimbatore launch. Phase is the build phase in section 10.

ID	Requirement	Priority	Phase
COM-1	Organiser creates a community: name, URL slug, city, category, tagline, description, logo, cover image, Instagram handle, WhatsApp group link	P0 Must	2

ID	Requirement	Priority	Phase
COM-2	A community is live at /c/{slug} as soon as it is created. The slug is unique and fixed after creation	P0 Must	2
COM-3	Public community page shows the about text, upcoming events, member count and a Join button	P0 Must	2
COM-4	Members join and leave. Hosts can ban a member, and a banned member cannot rejoin	P1 Should	2
COM-5	Owner adds or removes co-hosts by phone number or email	P1 Should	5
COM-6	Unlisted communities open by link but are hidden from discovery	P2 Could	2
EVT-1	Host creates a draft event: title, description, cover, venue, Maps link, start and end, optional capacity, pricing (free, paid or deposit), price, waitlist on or off, registration cutoff	P0 Must	2
EVT-2	Host publishes an event. Paid and deposit events are blocked until payouts are verified, with a link to payout setup	P0 Must	2
EVT-3	Public event page at /c/{slug}/{event} shows seats left, the price including the fee, and a Register button. The link shows a preview card in WhatsApp	P0 Must	2
EVT-4	Share button copies the link and opens WhatsApp with pre-filled text	P0 Must	2
EVT-5	Host edits a published event. The price locks after the first registration, and capacity can't drop below seats already taken	P0 Must	2
EVT-6	Host cancels a published event with a reason. Every registration is cancelled, every payment is refunded in full, and attendees are notified	P0 Must	4
EVT-7	After an event ends, it is marked complete (by the host or automatically after 24 hours), and anyone confirmed but not checked in becomes a no-show	P0 Must	5
EVT-8	Host duplicates a past event into a new draft	P1 Should	2
REG-1	A logged-in member registers for a free event in one tap and is confirmed at once if a seat is free	P0 Must	3

ID	Requirement	Priority	Phase
REG-2	A visitor who is not logged in signs in and lands back on the event with registration completed	P0 Must	3
REG-3	If the event is full and the waitlist is on, the person is waitlisted and sees their position	P0 Must	3
REG-4	When a seat frees up, the first waitlisted person is promoted. Free events confirm them automatically. For paid events they get a payment offer valid for 120 minutes, after which it passes to the next person	P0 Must	3–4
REG-5	Attendees can cancel until the cutoff (default 3 hours before start). The freed seat goes to the waitlist	P0 Must	3
REG-6	My tickets shows upcoming tickets with a QR code, plus past events	P0 Must	3
REG-7	Each person can hold only one live registration per event, and a second attempt gets a clear message	P0 Must	3
PAY-1	A paid or deposit registration holds a seat for 15 minutes and creates a Razorpay order for the ticket plus fee	P0 Must	4
PAY-2	Payments are verified on the server (signature and webhook). A success message from the browser is never trusted	P0 Must	4
PAY-3	If a payment arrives after its hold expired and the event has filled, it is refunded in full automatically and the attendee is told	P0 Must	4
PAY-4	A deposit is refunded automatically within 24 hours of check-in. The platform fee is kept (see open question Q1)	P0 Must	4
PAY-5	An attendee who cancels a paid ticket before the cutoff gets the ticket amount back. The fee is kept	P1 Should	4
PAY-6	Duplicate Razorpay webhooks never apply a payment or refund twice	P0 Must	4
CHK-1	Host check-in screen scans the attendee's QR code with the phone camera, shows name and status, and checks them in	P0 Must	5

ID	Requirement	Priority	Phase
CHK-2	Host checks people in by hand from a searchable guest list	P0 Must	5
CHK-3	Scanning a ticket that belongs to another event, was cancelled or was already used shows a clear error	P0 Must	5
CHK-4	Check-in retries on a weak connection and never checks anyone in twice	P1 Should	5
PO-1	Organiser submits payout details (Razorpay Route linked account: PAN and bank account)	P0 Must	5
PO-2	Admin queue to verify or reject payout accounts, with a reason	P0 Must	5
PO-3	Organiser sees revenue per event: gross tickets, refunds, net payable and settlement status	P1 Should	5
NOT-1	Confirmation with the ticket link sent on WhatsApp (SMS as fallback) after registering	P1 Should	6
NOT-2	Reminder sent 12 hours before the event starts	P1 Should	6
NOT-3	Messages for waitlist offer, event cancelled and refund issued	P1 Should	6
DIS-1	City page lists upcoming public events by date and category	P1 Should	6
ANA-1	Host sees each event's registered, waitlisted and checked-in counts, show-up rate and revenue	P1 Should	5
ANA-2	Community view lists regulars (3+ events in 8 weeks) and members who went quiet (none in 4 weeks)	P2 Could	6
ADM-1	Admin suspends a user or community. A suspended community's pages are hidden and registration is blocked	P0 Must	5
ADM-2	Admin edits platform settings: fee %, minimum fee, hold minutes, cancel cutoff	P1 Should	5

5. Business rules

Attendees pay a 4% fee (minimum ₹5) on top of paid tickets. Free events carry no fee. Every value below is a platform setting the admin can change without a code release.

Rule	Default	Setting key
Platform fee on paid and deposit tickets, paid by the attendee	4% of ticket price	platform_fee_percentage
Minimum platform fee	₹5	platform_fee_min_paise
Seat hold while paying	15 minutes	payment_hold_minutes
Waitlist payment offer stays open	120 minutes	waitlist_offer_minutes
Attendee self-cancel cutoff before start	3 hours	attendee_cancel_cutoff_minutes
Maximum ticket price	₹1,00,000	fixed in schema
Maximum capacity	10,000	fixed in schema

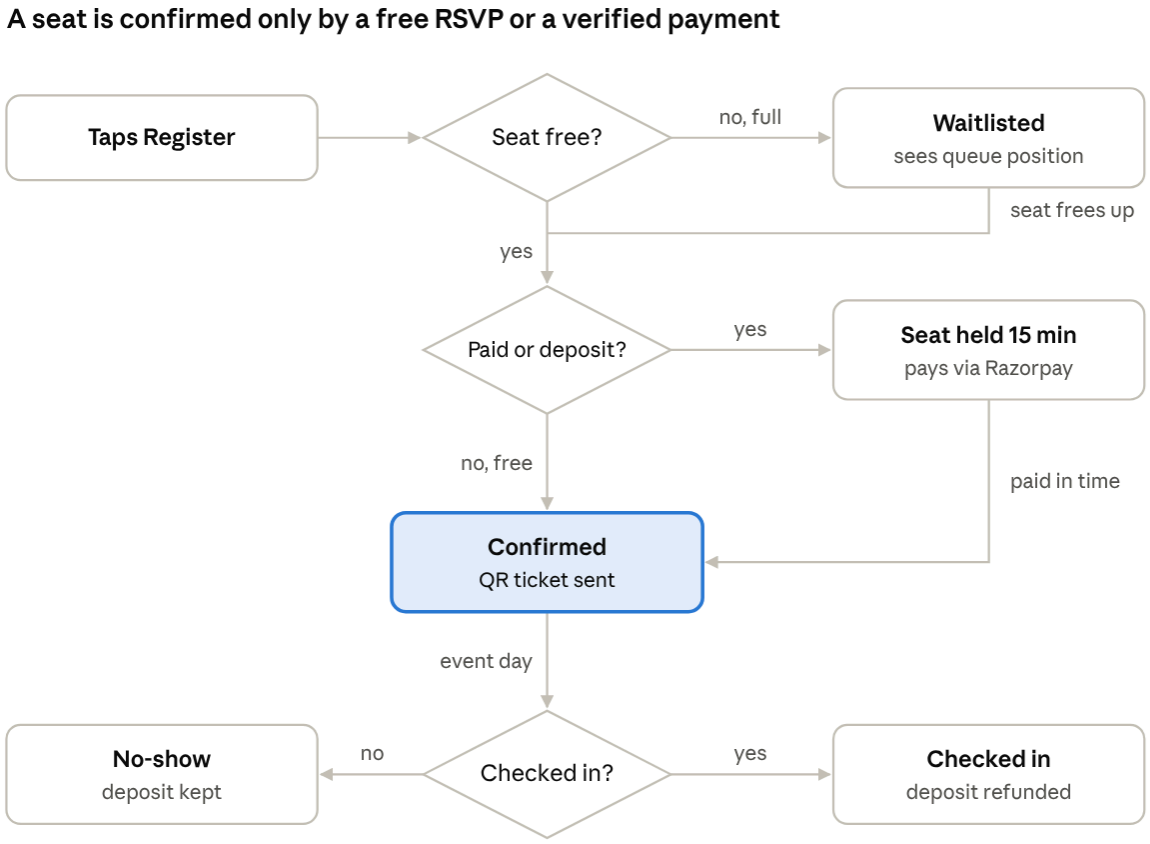
Worked example. A ₹299 ticket carries a ₹11.96 fee, so the attendee pays ₹310.96. The organiser is owed ₹299. Razorpay's charge (about 2%, to confirm on the live plan) is paid out of the fee.

Rules the database enforces

- **Seats taken** = confirmed + checked in + no-show + payment holds that haven't expired. The last seat can never be sold twice.
- **One live ticket** per person per event.
- **Free event:** confirmed instantly if a seat is free, otherwise waitlisted.
- **Paid event:** confirmed only by a verified payment, never directly.
- **Deposit event:** works like a paid event. The ticket amount is refunded after check-in. No-shows forfeit it to the organiser.
- **Paid and deposit events** cannot go live until the community's payouts are verified.
- **Price** locks after the first registration. **Capacity** can never drop below seats taken.
- **A late payment** whose hold expired after the event filled is refunded in full.
- **Host cancels the event:** every attendee gets back the ticket and the fee.
- **Attendee cancels before the cutoff:** gets the ticket amount back; the fee is kept. After the cutoff, no refund.
- **Money is stored in paise** as whole numbers. Each ticket keeps the fee and amounts that applied when it was bought, even if the settings change later.

6. Key user flows

The attendee flow depends on two questions: is a seat free, and does the event cost money?



attendee registration flow · 3 decisions, 6 states

If a payment hold lapses, the seat goes to the next person. A payment that arrives after the event has filled is refunded (PAY-3).

Organiser flow

1. Sign up with Google or email and create the community (COM-1).
2. For paid events, submit payout details and wait for admin verification (PO-1, PO-2).
3. Create a draft event, then publish it (EVT-1, EVT-2).
4. Share the link in the WhatsApp group (EVT-4).
5. Watch registrations and the waitlist fill up (ANA-1).
6. On event day, open Check-in and scan QR codes (CHK-1).
7. After the event, mark it complete. No-shows are recorded and deposits settle (EVT-7, PAY-4).

7. Non-functional requirements

The app must work on a mid-range Android phone on 4G, because that is where attendees tap the WhatsApp link.

ID	Area	Requirement
NFR-1	Performance	Event page loads in under 2.5 s (LCP) on a mid-range Android over 4G
NFR-2	Performance	Registration and check-in API calls respond in under 500 ms at p95
NFR-3	Scale	A hot event with 500 seats survives 2,000 people registering within 60 seconds, with zero oversold seats
NFR-4	Reliability	Payment confirmation never depends on n8n or notifications. If they fail, the ticket is still confirmed
NFR-5	Reliability	Every Razorpay webhook is idempotent, and a nightly job reconciles orders against payments
NFR-6	Security	Row-level security on every table. The browser can never write tickets, payments, payout status or settings
NFR-7	Security	The service-role key and Razorpay secrets live only on the server. A leaked browser key gives no access beyond what RLS allows
NFR-8	Security	QR check-in tokens are random and at least 128 bits, so they can't be guessed
NFR-9	Privacy	Under India's DPDP Act: collect only name, phone and email; show a consent notice at signup; let users delete their account
NFR-10	Privacy	Hosts see attendee names and check-in status, not phone numbers, unless the attendee opts in
NFR-11	Payments	No card or UPI details are stored. Razorpay handles all of it
NFR-12	Observability	Structured JSON logs with request_id, user_id and event_id. Errors are logged on the server, and the browser gets a safe message

ID	Area	Requirement
NFR-13	Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA contrast, 44 px touch targets, and every flow usable with a keyboard
NFR-14	Quality	Every change passes lint, typecheck, unit and database tests, and a production build before merge
NFR-15	Localisation	English at launch. Every user-facing string sits in one place so Tamil can be added in Phase 6

8. Data model

There are 11 tables in Supabase Postgres, already built and tested in Phase 1 (supabase/migrations in the repo).

Table	Holds	Key fields	Who can write it
users	One profile per login	role (MEMBER, ORGANIZER, ADMIN), name, phone, email, status	Self (name, phone, avatar); admin (role)
cities	Launch cities	name, slug, timezone, is_active	Migrations and admin
categories	Community types	name, slug, sort_order	Migrations and admin
communities	A club or group	owner_id, city, category, slug, visibility, status, payout_status	Organiser creates; hosts edit; admin sets status and payouts
community_hosts	Owner and co-hosts	community_id, user_id, role (OWNER, CO_HOST)	Trigger adds the owner; owner adds co-hosts
community_members	Who joined	community_id, user_id, status (ACTIVE, LEFT, BANNED)	Self joins or leaves; hosts ban

Table	Holds	Key fields	Who can write it
events	One gathering	community_id, starts_at, ends_at, capacity, pricing, price, status	Hosts create, edit and publish; server cancels or completes
registrations	One person's ticket	event_id, user_id, status, ticket_amount, platform_fee, total_amount, hold_expires_at, check_in_token, checked_in_at	Server only
payments	A Razorpay order and its refund	registration_id, provider_order_id, provider_payment_id, amount, status, refund_status, refund_amount	Server only
notifications	Outbound message log	user_id, registration_id, type, channel, status	Server only
platform_settings	Configurable rules (section 5)	key, value	Server only

Relations: a community has many hosts, members and events. An event has many registrations. A registration has zero or more payments.

9. Success metrics and launch criteria

The north-star metric is checked-in attendees per week. Signups and page views don't count.

Metric	Definition	90-day target
Checked-in attendees per week	Registrations moved to CHECKED_IN in a week	1,000
Active communities	Communities with 2+ events in the last 4 weeks	20 in Coimbatore
Event coverage	Share of a community's events run through Kootam	80%

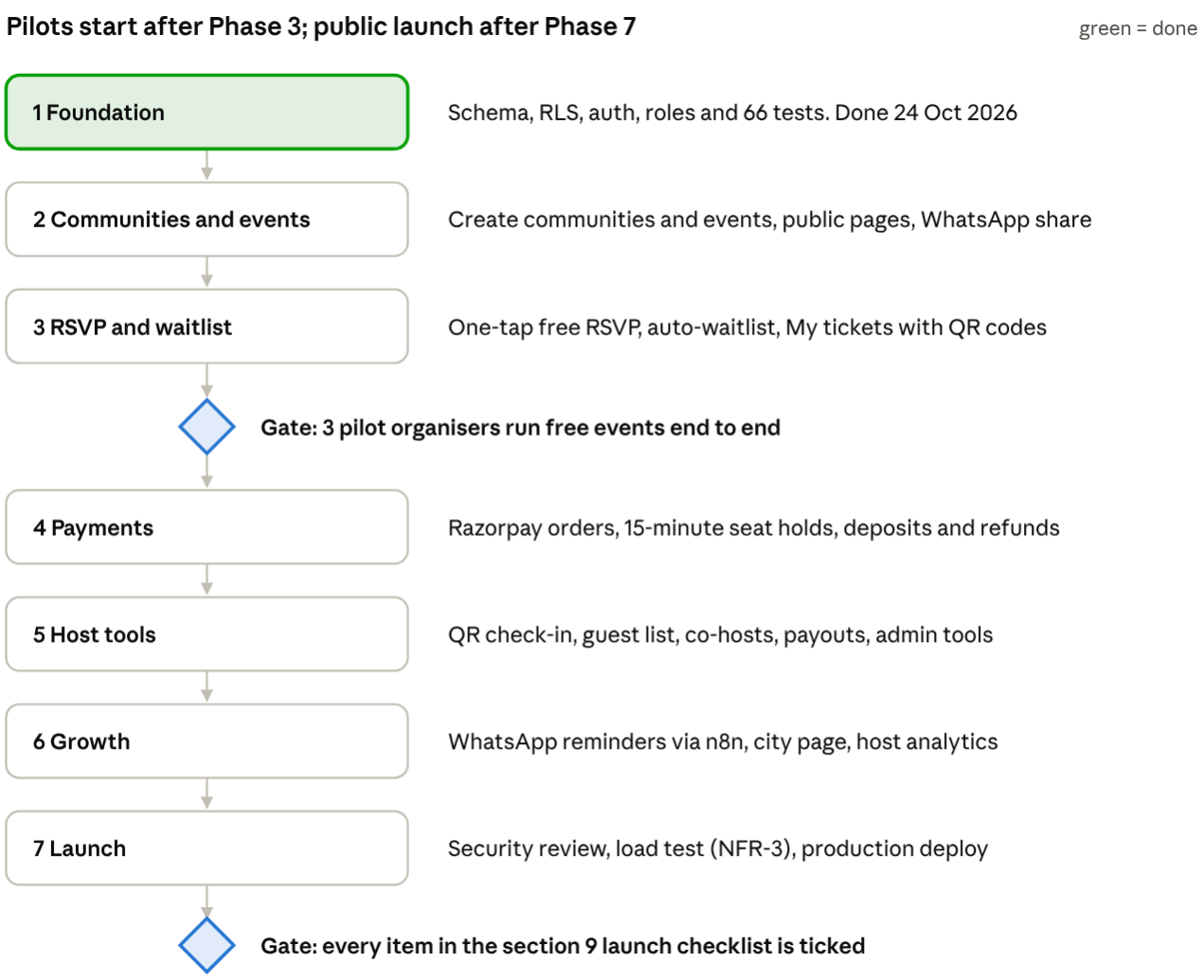
Metric	Definition	90-day target
Show-up rate	Checked in ÷ confirmed, for deposit events	85%
Attendee retention	Attendees at a second event within 4 weeks	40%
Organic growth	New attendees whose first visit came from a shared event link	70%
Payment success	Paid orders captured ÷ orders created	90%

Launch checklist (all must be true before the first real event)

- [ ] Every P0 requirement in section 4 is done and passing its tests
- [ ] Load test passes NFR-3 on staging with zero oversold seats
- [ ] A real ₹1 payment, refund and deposit refund verified end to end on Razorpay live mode
- [ ] Security review done: RLS, secrets, webhooks, the QR token
- [ ] 3 pilot organisers have each run one event on staging
- [ ] Privacy notice and terms published; refund policy shown on every paid event page
- [ ] Phone OTP works on real Indian numbers (DLT-registered SMS template)

10. Release phases, open questions and risks

Phase 1 is done. Real organisers start piloting after Phase 3, and the public launch waits until Phase 7. Stop after each phase for review.



build roadmap · 7 phases, 2 gates

Payments come after the pilot gate, so the first pilots run on free events while payout verification is set up.

Open questions

- [ ] Q1. On a deposit refund, does the attendee get the platform fee back too? (affects PAY-4)
- [ ] Q2. Who absorbs Razorpay's charge when a host cancels and everything is refunded?
- [ ] Q3. Payouts: Razorpay Route split at capture, or weekly manual settlement during the pilot?
- [ ] Q4. OTP channel: SMS (needs DLT registration and costs per message) or WhatsApp OTP?
- [ ] Q5. GST: does Kootam charge 18% GST on the platform fee, and from what turnover? Needs a CA's advice.
- [ ] Q6. Final brand name and domain.

Risks

Risk	What it costs	Mitigation
Organisers stay on WhatsApp and UPI	No supply, so no attendees	Free to use; set up their first event for them; lead with deposits, which fix their no-show problem
Attendees push back on the fee	Fewer paid registrations	₹5 minimum; test 3% against 4%; show that the organiser gets the full ticket price
District or Luma copies the features	Slower growth	Own recurring communities in Coimbatore first; member and attendance history makes switching costly
A bug in payments or refunds	Organisers and attendees lose trust	Rules enforced in the database, idempotent webhooks, nightly reconciliation, load test before launch
Payout KYC takes days	Organisers can't sell paid tickets yet	Pilot on free events; admin verifies quickly; Q3 decides the pilot model